ENGLISH Mids MCQs

Functional English — Department of English

86 MCQs | Medium & Hard | All Topics Covered | ✔ Correct Answer Highlighted

SECTION 1: THE SENTENCE & ITS KINDS

Q1. Which of the following BEST defines a sentence? ● MED

A) Any group of words written together

✔ **B) A group of words that makes complete sense**

C) A group of words containing only a verb

D) A group of words beginning with a capital letter

■ *A sentence is defined as 'a group of words which makes complete sense.' A phrase, by contrast, makes sense but not complete sense.*

Q2. 'Humpty Dumpty sat on a wall.' Which kind of sentence is this? ● MED

A) Interrogative

B) Imperative

C) Exclamatory

✔ **D) Declarative/Assertive**

■ *A sentence that makes a statement or assertion is called Declarative or Assertive. 'Humpty Dumpty sat on a wall' asserts a fact.*

Q3. 'Where do you live?' — What type of sentence is this? ● MED

A) Imperative

B) Exclamatory

✔ **C) Interrogative**

D) Declarative

■ *A sentence that asks a question is called an Interrogative sentence. 'Where do you live?' asks a question, so it is interrogative.*

Q4. 'Be quiet.' — Identify the type of sentence. ● MED

A) Declarative

B) Interrogative

C) Exclamatory

✔ **D) Imperative**

■ *A sentence that expresses a command, request, or entreaty is called Imperative. 'Be quiet' is a command, hence imperative.*

Q5. 'How cold the night is!' — This sentence is: ● MED

A) Declarative

B) Imperative

✔ **C) Exclamatory**

D) Interrogative

■ *A sentence that expresses a strong feeling is called Exclamatory. 'How cold the night is!' expresses the strong feeling of coldness.*

Q6. In Imperative sentences, the Subject is generally: ● HARD

A) Stated explicitly at the beginning
B) Placed after the predicate
✔ **C) Left out but understood to be 'You'**
D) Replaced by a pronoun at the end

■ *In Imperative sentences the Subject (You) is left out. E.g., 'Sit down' really means 'You sit down' — the subject is understood, not written.*

Q7. In the sentence 'Here comes the bus,' the Subject is placed: ● HARD

A) Before the verb
✔ **B) After the predicate**
C) At the very end
D) It has no subject

■ *Normally the subject comes first, but occasionally it is put AFTER the predicate. In 'Here comes the bus,' 'the bus' is the subject and it comes after the predicate 'here comes.'*

Q8. Which sentence correctly illustrates ALL four kinds of sentences in sequence — Declarative, Interrogative, Imperative, Exclamatory? ● HARD

✔ **A) She sings well. Does she sing? Sing! What a voice!**
B) What a voice! Does she sing? She sings well. Sing!
C) Sing! She sings well. What a voice! Does she sing?
D) Does she sing? Sing! What a voice! She sings well.

■ *The sequence Declarative ('She sings well') → Interrogative ('Does she sing?') → Imperative ('Sing!') → Exclamatory ('What a voice!') matches the exact order of the four kinds.*

SECTION 2: SUBJECT & PREDICATE

Q9. Every sentence has two parts. They are called: ● MED

A) Noun and Verb
✔ **B) Subject and Predicate**
C) Clause and Phrase
D) Topic and Comment

■ *Every sentence has (1) a Subject — the part naming the person or thing spoken about, and (2) a Predicate — the part that says something about the subject.*

Q10. The part of a sentence which tells something about the Subject is called the: ● MED

A) Object
B) Clause
✔ **C) Predicate**
D) Complement

■ *The Predicate is the part of the sentence that tells something about the Subject. The Subject names the person/thing; the Predicate makes a statement about it.*

Q11. In 'The horse kicked the boy,' what is the Subject? ● MED

A) kicked
B) the boy
✔ **C) the horse**
D) boy

■ *The Subject is the performer of the action — who kicked? 'The horse' kicked, so 'the horse' is the Subject. To find the subject, ask 'Who?' or 'What?' before the verb.*

Q12. In 'Sweet are the uses of adversity,' the Subject is: ● HARD

A) Sweet
B) are
C) adversity
✔ **D) the uses of adversity**

■ *Even though the subject follows the predicate here, 'the uses of adversity' is what the sentence is about. 'Sweet are' is the predicate placed first for stylistic effect.*

Q13. In 'Thank him,' the implied but unstated subject is: ● HARD

A) He
B) Him
✔ **C) You**
D) They

■ *In Imperative sentences, the subject 'You' is understood but not written. 'Thank him' means 'You thank him' — the subject You is implied.*

SECTION 3: PHRASE AND CLAUSE

Q14. What is a Phrase? ● MED

A) A group of words that makes complete sense
✔ **B) A group of words which makes sense but not complete sense**
C) A group of words with a subject and a predicate
D) A single word used as a sentence

■ *A Phrase makes sense but NOT complete sense. For example, 'in a corner' makes some sense but cannot stand alone as a complete thought.*

Q15. Which of the following is a PHRASE (not a clause)? ● MED

A) which is made of gold
B) while it is raining
✔ **C) in the east**
D) who pay their debts

■ *'In the east' is a phrase — it makes sense but has no subject or predicate. The other options all contain a subject + predicate, making them clauses.*

Q16. What distinguishes a Clause from a Phrase? ● MED

A) A clause is longer than a phrase

✔ **B) A clause contains a subject and a predicate; a phrase does not**

C) A clause appears only at the start of a sentence

D) A phrase always contains a verb; a clause does not

■ *The key difference: a Clause contains BOTH a Subject and a Predicate (e.g., 'which is made of gold'). A Phrase lacks either one and cannot make complete sense on its own.*

Q17. In 'People who pay their debts are trusted,' the clause in italics ('who pay their debts') functions as: ● MED

A) The main clause

B) A phrase

✔ **C) A subordinate clause**

D) An independent sentence

■ *'Who pay their debts' has a subject ('who') and a predicate ('pay their debts') and forms part of the sentence — this makes it a clause. Since it cannot stand alone, it is a subordinate (dependent) clause.*

Q18. Examine: 'He has a chain of gold' vs 'He has a chain which is made of gold.' The underlined portion in the second sentence is a clause because: ● HARD

A) It contains more words than the phrase

B) It is placed after a noun

✔ **C) It contains a subject ('which') and a predicate ('is made of gold')**

D) It begins with the word 'which'

■ *A clause is defined by the presence of both a subject AND predicate. 'Which' is the subject and 'is made of gold' is the predicate — together they form a clause, unlike the mere phrase 'of gold.'*

Q19. In 'I think that you have made a mistake,' the italicized clause ('that you have made a mistake') is best described as: ● HARD

A) An independent clause

B) A phrase acting as a subject

✔ **C) A clause forming part of the sentence with its own subject and predicate**

D) A predicate with no subject

■ *'You' is the subject and 'have made a mistake' is the predicate — together they form a clause. This clause forms part of the larger sentence, making it a subordinate/dependent clause.*

SECTION 4: PARTS OF SPEECH

Q20. How many Parts of Speech are there in English? ● MED

A) Six

B) Seven

✔ **C) Eight**

D) Ten

■ *According to the material, words are divided into eight Parts of Speech: Noun, Adjective, Pronoun, Verb, Adverb, Preposition, Conjunction, and Interjection.*

Q21. A Verb is a word used to express: ● MED

A) The name of a person or thing

✔ **B) An action or state**

C) A relation between nouns

D) A quality or description

■ *A Verb expresses an action or state. E.g., 'wrote' (action) in 'The girl wrote a letter,' or 'is' (state) in 'Kolkata is a big city.'*

Q22. An Adverb is used to add something to the meaning of: ● MED

A) Only nouns

B) Only verbs

✔ **C) A verb, an adjective, or another adverb**

D) Only adjectives

■ *An Adverb adds meaning to a VERB (worked quickly), an ADJECTIVE (very beautiful), or another ADVERB (quite correctly) — all three are explicitly listed in the definition.*

Q23. A Preposition is used with a noun or pronoun to show: ● MED

A) Its gender

B) Its number

✔ **C) How the person or thing stands in relation to something else**

D) Whether it is countable or uncountable

■ *A Preposition shows the RELATIONSHIP between a noun/pronoun and something else. E.g., 'in the garden' — 'in' shows the cow's relationship to the garden.*

Q24. An Interjection expresses: ● MED

A) A joining of clauses

✔ **B) A sudden feeling**

C) A relation between words

D) A quality of a noun

■ *An Interjection expresses a sudden feeling. 'Hurrah!' expresses joy and 'Alas!' expresses sorrow — both are sudden emotional outbursts.*

Q25. In 'They arrived soon after' (Adverb), 'They arrived after us' (Preposition), 'They arrived after we had left' (Conjunction) — what does this demonstrate? ● HARD

A) That 'after' is always a conjunction

✔ **B) That the same word can function as different parts of speech depending on its use in a sentence**

C) That adverbs always come before prepositions

D) That conjunctions replace prepositions in formal writing

■ *The same word 'after' functions as an Adverb, Preposition, and Conjunction in different sentences. This shows that a word's part of speech depends entirely on how it is USED in the sentence.*

Q26. Determiners such as 'a, an, the, this, that, every, some' are: ● HARD

A) Always classified as pronouns

✔ **B) Modern grammars include them among parts of speech; all except a, an, the are classed among adjectives**

C) A separate ninth part of speech replacing adjectives

D) Used only with verbs

■ *Some modern grammars include determiners among the parts of speech. Determiners determine/limit the meaning of nouns that follow. All determiners EXCEPT a, an, and the are classed among adjectives.*

Q27. A Conjunction is used to: ● HARD

A) Show the relation of a noun to something else

B) Add meaning to a verb

✔ **C) Join words or sentences**

D) Express a sudden feeling

■ *A Conjunction joins words or sentences. E.g., 'and' in 'Rama AND Hari are cousins' joins two words; 'but' in 'I ran fast, BUT missed the train' joins two clauses.*

Q28. Which part of speech is the word 'fond' in 'The girl is fond of music'? ● HARD

A) Noun

B) Adverb

✔ **C) Adjective**

D) Preposition

■ *'Fond' describes the girl's quality/feeling — it is an Adjective used predicatively (after the verb 'is' as part of the predicate). It adds meaning to the noun 'girl.'*

SECTION 5: NOUNS: KINDS

Q29. A Common Noun is: ● MED

A) The name of a particular person or place

✔ **B) A name given in common to every person or thing of the same class or kind**

C) The name of a quality or action

D) A number of persons taken together as one whole

■ *A Common Noun is shared by ALL members of a class. 'King' can apply to any king. 'Girl' can apply to any girl. It is common to all, unlike a Proper Noun which names a specific individual.*

Q30. Which of the following is a Proper Noun? ● MED

A) city

B) country

✔ **C) Karachi**

D) king

■ *A Proper Noun names a PARTICULAR person or place. 'Karachi' names a specific city. 'City', 'country', and 'king' are Common Nouns — they can refer to any city, country, or king.*

Q31. A Collective Noun is: ● MED

A) The name of a quality or state

B) A name common to all members of a class

✔ **C) The name of a collection of persons or things spoken of as one whole**

D) The name of a particular person

■ *A Collective Noun names a COLLECTION spoken of as one whole. Examples: crowd, team, fleet, army, jury. 'The jury found the prisoner guilty' — jury is one whole group.*

Q32. 'Laughter, theft, movement' — these are examples of which type of noun? ● MED

A) Collective Nouns

✔ **B) Abstract Nouns denoting Action**

C) Common Nouns

D) Proper Nouns

■ *Abstract Nouns include names of qualities, actions, and states. 'Laughter,' 'theft,' and 'movement' all denote ACTIONS — they are Abstract Nouns of action.*

Q33. Which Abstract Noun is formed from a Common Noun? ● HARD

A) Kindness (from kind)

B) Obedience (from obey)

✔ **C) Childhood (from child)**

D) Honesty (from honest)

■ *Abstract Nouns are formed from: (1) Adjectives — e.g., kindness from kind, honesty from honest; (2) Verbs — e.g., obedience from obey; (3) Common Nouns — e.g., CHILDHOOD from child, slavery from slave.*

Q34. Which is an UNCOUNTABLE noun? ● HARD

A) book

B) pen

C) apple

✔ **D) milk**

■ *Uncountable nouns cannot be counted and have no plural form. 'Milk' is uncountable (we cannot say 'milks'). Book, pen, and apple are countable — they have plurals: books, pens, apples.*

Q35. Proper Nouns are sometimes used as Common Nouns. In 'Kalidas is often called the Shakespeare of India,' 'Shakespeare' is used as: ● HARD

A) A Proper Noun referring to the English playwright

✔ **B) A Common Noun meaning 'the greatest dramatist'**

C) An Abstract Noun denoting skill

D) A Collective Noun for dramatists

■ *When Proper Nouns are used as Common Nouns, they carry a general meaning. Here 'Shakespeare' = 'the greatest dramatist.' It is used as a Common Noun to describe a TYPE of person, not the specific individual.*

Q36. The names of Arts and Sciences like grammar, music, and chemistry are classified as: ● HARD

A) Collective Nouns

B) Common Nouns

✔ **C) Abstract Nouns**

D) Proper Nouns

■ *The material explicitly states: 'The names of the Arts and Science (e.g., grammar, music, chemistry, etc.) are also Abstract Nouns.' They denote subjects of thought rather than physical objects.*

Q37. Proper Nouns are ALWAYS written with: ● HARD

A) All capital letters

✔ **B) A capital letter at the beginning**

C) Quotation marks

D) An apostrophe

■ *Note 1 in the material states: 'Proper Nouns are always written with a capital letter at the beginning.' Only the FIRST letter is capitalised, not the entire word.*

SECTION 6: NOUNS: GENDER

Q38. A noun that denotes a male animal is said to be of the _____ Gender. ● MED

A) Feminine
B) Common
C) Neuter
✔ **D) Masculine**

■ *Masculine Gender denotes MALE animals or persons. Feminine Gender denotes females. This is the basic distinction introduced in the gender section.*

Q39. Which of the following is of the COMMON Gender? ● MED

A) Lion
B) Lioness
✔ **C) Student**
D) King

■ *Common Gender nouns denote EITHER male or female. 'Student' can be male or female. 'Lion' is masculine, 'Lioness' is feminine, 'King' is masculine.*

Q40. A noun denoting a thing without life (neither male nor female) is of the _____ Gender. ● MED

A) Masculine
B) Feminine
C) Common
✔ **D) Neuter**

■ *Neuter Gender applies to things without life. 'Book, pen, room, tree' are neither male nor female. 'Neuter' means 'neither.'*

Q41. The feminine of 'Duke' is formed by: ● MED

A) Using an entirely different word
✔ **B) Adding -ess after dropping the vowel of the masculine ending → Duchess**
C) Placing a word before the masculine
D) Adding -ine to the masculine

■ *'Duke' → 'Duchess': the vowel 'e' is dropped and '-ess' is added. This follows Method 2 — adding a syllable (-ess) after dropping the masculine ending vowel.*

Q42. The Moon, the Earth, Spring, and Nature are personified as: ● HARD

A) Masculine — remarkable for strength
✔ **B) Feminine — remarkable for beauty, gentleness, and gracefulness**
C) Neuter — things without life
D) Common — they can be either gender

■ *Objects remarkable for beauty, gentleness, and gracefulness are given Feminine Gender when personified. The material explicitly lists: Moon, Earth, Spring, Autumn, Nature, Liberty, Justice, Mercy, Peace, Hope, Charity.*

Q43. The Sun, Summer, Winter, Time, and Death are personified as: ● HARD

A) Feminine
B) Neuter
✔ **C) Masculine — remarkable for strength and violence**
D) Common

■ *The material states: 'The Masculine Gender is often applied to objects remarkable for strength and violence' — specifically listing the Sun, Summer, Winter, Time, and Death as masculine.*

Q44. What is the feminine of 'Drake'? ● HARD

A) Hen
B) Goose
✔ **C) Duck**
D) Doe

■ *'Drake' (male duck) → 'Duck' (female). This is formed by using an ENTIRELY different word (Method 1). 'Hen' is feminine of cock; 'Goose' is feminine of gander; 'Doe' is feminine of hart.*

SECTION 7: NOUNS: CASE

Q45. When a noun is used as the Subject of a verb, it is said to be in the _____ Case. ● MED

A) Accusative
B) Possessive
✔ **C) Nominative**
D) Genitive

■ *The Nominative Case is used for the SUBJECT of a verb. To find the Nominative, put 'Who?' or 'What?' before the verb.*

Q46. When a noun is used as the Object of a verb, it is in the _____ Case. ● MED

A) Nominative
✔ **B) Objective (Accusative)**
C) Possessive
D) Genitive

■ *The Objective (or Accusative) Case is used for the OBJECT of a verb — the receiver of the action. To find it, ask 'Whom?' or 'What?' before the verb and its subject.*

Q47. In 'Rama gave Hari a ball,' the Indirect Object is: ● MED

A) ball
B) gave
✔ **C) Hari**
D) Rama

■ *'Hari' is the Indirect Object — the person TO WHOM the ball was given. 'Ball' is the Direct Object. The Indirect Object comes immediately after the verb and before the Direct Object.*

Q48. The Possessive Case answers the question: ● MED

A) Who?
B) Whom?
C) What?
✔ **D) Whose?**

■ *The Possessive (or Genitive) Case shows ownership or possession and answers the question 'WHOSE?' — e.g., 'Whose umbrella? — Rama's.'*

Q49. In 'The book is in the desk,' the noun 'desk' is in which case, and why? ● HARD

A) Nominative — it is the subject
✔ **B) Accusative — it comes after the preposition 'in'**
C) Possessive — it shows ownership
D) It has no case because it follows 'is'

■ *A noun coming after a PREPOSITION is in the Accusative Case. 'Desk' follows the preposition 'in,' so it is governed by that preposition and is in the Accusative Case.*

Q50. When forming the Possessive Case of a PLURAL noun ending in 's' (e.g., boys), we: ● HARD

A) Add 's → boys's
✔ **B) Add only an apostrophe → boys'**
C) Add nothing — no change needed
D) Drop the final 's' and add 'es'

■ *Rule: Plural nouns ending in 's' form the Possessive by adding ONLY an apostrophe (no extra 's'). So 'boys' → 'boys\',' 'girls' → 'girls\',' 'horses' → 'horses\'.*

Q51. In 'Raja Rao's and R.K. Narayan's novels,' the possessive sign appears on BOTH names. This is because: ● HARD

A) It is always doubled for emphasis
✔ **B) Each noun implies SEPARATE possession, so each takes the possessive sign**
C) Both names end in a vowel
D) The rule applies only to proper nouns

■ *When two nouns imply SEPARATE possession, EACH must take the possessive sign. Raja Rao has his novels; R.K. Narayan has his. Compare: 'Karim and Salim's bakery' (joint ownership — only the last takes the sign).*

Q52. The Possessive Case is generally NOT used with inanimate objects. Which is the CORRECT form? ● HARD

A) The table's leg
B) The book's cover
✔ **C) The leg of the table**
D) The roof's house

■ *The Possessive Case is used chiefly with LIVING things. For inanimate objects, we use 'of' + noun. So 'the leg of the table' is correct, NOT 'the table's leg.'*

Q53. 'A week's holiday,' 'a day's march,' 'in a year's time' — the Possessive is used here because: ● HARD

A) These are living things

✔ **B) The Possessive is used with nouns denoting time, space, or weight**

C) These are personified objects

D) These are proper nouns

■ *Exception to the living-things rule: the Possessive is also used with nouns denoting TIME, SPACE, or WEIGHT. 'A week's holiday,' 'a mile's distance,' 'a pound's worth' all follow this rule.*

SECTION 8: NOUNS IN APPOSITION

Q54. In 'Rama, our captain, made fifty runs,' the noun 'captain' is said to be: ● MED

A) In the Accusative Case

B) An Indirect Object

✔ **C) In apposition to 'Rama'**

D) A Possessive Noun

■ *'Captain' follows 'Rama' to describe/identify the same person. When one noun follows another to describe it, it is said to be in APPOSITION. It takes the same case as the noun it explains.*

Q55. In 'Yesterday I met your uncle, the doctor,' the noun 'doctor' in apposition is in: ● HARD

A) Nominative Case

✔ **B) Accusative Case**

C) Possessive Case

D) Genitive Case

■ *'Uncle' is the Object of 'met' (Accusative Case). Since 'doctor' is in apposition to 'uncle,' it takes the SAME case — Accusative. A noun in apposition always matches the case of the noun it explains.*

Q56. What does 'Apposition' literally mean? ● HARD

A) Placed opposite

✔ **B) Placed near**

C) Placed before

D) Placed after

■ *The material states: '[Apposition means placing near.]' A noun in apposition is placed NEAR the noun it describes to identify or explain it.*

SECTION 9: THE ADJECTIVE

Q57. An Adjective is a word used with a noun to: ● MED

A) Replace the noun entirely

✔ **B) Add something to its meaning — to describe, point out, or indicate number/quantity**

C) Show the action performed by the noun

D) Connect the noun to another clause

■ *An Adjective 'adds something to the meaning of a noun.' It describes, points out the person/thing, or tells the number or quantity. The word 'Adjective' literally means 'added to.'*

Q58. In 'The lazy boy was punished,' the adjective 'lazy' is used: ● MED

A) Predicatively
✔ **B) Attributively**
C) As a noun
D) As an adverb

■ *'Lazy' is used DIRECTLY with the noun 'boy' as an epithet/attribute — it comes right before the noun. This is called Attributive use. In 'The boy is lazy,' it would be used Predicatively (after the verb).*

Q59. Adjectives of Quality answer the question: ● MED

A) How many?
B) How much?
✔ **C) Of what kind?**
D) Which one?

■ *Adjectives of Quality (Descriptive Adjectives) describe the KIND or quality of a person or thing. They answer 'Of what kind?' — e.g., large city, honest man, foolish crow.*

Q60. Which type of adjective shows HOW MUCH of a thing is meant? ● MED

A) Adjective of Quality
B) Adjective of Number
✔ **C) Adjective of Quantity**
D) Distributive Adjective

■ *Adjectives of Quantity answer 'How much?' — e.g., some rice, much patience, little intelligence, all wealth. They refer to quantity, not number of countable items.*

Q61. Cardinals (one, two, three…) and Ordinals (first, second, third…) are types of: ● MED

A) Indefinite Numeral Adjectives
✔ **B) Definite Numeral Adjectives**
C) Distributive Numeral Adjectives
D) Adjectives of Quantity

■ *Definite Numeral Adjectives denote an EXACT number. Cardinals (one, two…) say HOW MANY; Ordinals (first, second…) show the ORDER in a series. Both are definite because they give an exact number.*

Q62. 'Each boy must take his turn.' The adjective 'each' is best classified as: ● HARD

A) Indefinite Numeral Adjective
B) Adjective of Quantity
✔ **C) Distributive Numeral Adjective**
D) Adjective of Quality

■ *Distributive Numeral Adjectives refer to EACH ONE of a number individually. Each, every, either, neither — these distribute the meaning one at a time. 'Each boy' refers to every boy individually.*

Q63. Words like 'all, no, many, few, some, any, certain, several' are classified as: ● HARD

A) Definite Numeral Adjectives
✔ **B) Indefinite Numeral Adjectives**
C) Distributive Numeral Adjectives
D) Adjectives of Quantity

■ *Indefinite Numeral Adjectives do NOT denote an exact number. 'Many, few, some, several' — none gives a precise count. This contrasts with Definite Numerals (one, two, first…) which give exact numbers.*

Q64. Some Adjectives can be used ONLY Predicatively. Which sentence illustrates this? ● HARD

A) The afraid girl ran away.

✔ **B) She is afraid of ghosts.**

C) The well student answered.

D) The asleep baby cried.

■ *'Afraid' can ONLY be used predicatively (after a verb like 'is'). We cannot say 'the afraid girl' or 'the asleep baby.' The material explicitly notes: 'She is afraid of ghosts. I am quite well' as predicative-only adjectives.*

Q65. Adjectives formed from Proper Nouns (e.g., French, Turkish, Indian) are called: ● HARD

A) Abstract Adjectives

✔ **B) Proper Adjectives**

C) Distributive Adjectives

D) Possessive Adjectives

■ *The material states that adjectives formed from Proper Nouns (French, Turkish, Indian) are called PROPER ADJECTIVES and are 'generally classed with Adjectives of Quality.'*

SECTION 10: ARTICLES

Q66. Which article is called the INDEFINITE Article? ● MED

A) the

✔ **B) a or an**

C) both a/an and the

D) neither — articles are not indefinite

■ *'A or an' is the Indefinite Article because it usually leaves indefinite the person or thing spoken of. 'A doctor' means ANY doctor, not a specific one.*

Q67. The choice between 'a' and 'an' is determined by: ● MED

A) The spelling of the following word

✔ **B) The sound (vowel or consonant sound) at the start of the following word**

C) Whether the noun is countable or uncountable

D) Whether the noun is singular or plural

■ *'An' is used before a VOWEL SOUND; 'a' before a CONSONANT SOUND — regardless of spelling. 'An hour' (h is silent → vowel sound); 'a university' (begins with 'yoo' sound → consonant sound).*

Q68. Which correctly uses 'an'? ● MED

A) a honest man

B) an university

✔ **C) an hour**

D) a umbrella

■ *'An hour' is correct because 'hour' begins with a VOWEL SOUND — the 'h' is silent, making the first sound 'ow'. 'A honest man,' 'an university,' and 'a umbrella' are all incorrect.*

Q69. The Definite Article 'the' is used when we talk about: ● MED

A) Any person or thing in general

✔ **B) A particular person/thing or one already referred to**

C) Uncountable nouns only

D) Plural nouns only

■ *'The' is the Definite Article — it points to a PARTICULAR person or thing, or one already referred to, making it clear WHICH ONE is meant. E.g., 'The book you want is out of print.'*

Q70. 'A university,' 'a union,' 'a European' — 'a' (not 'an') is used before these because: ● HARD

A) They begin with a vowel letter 'u' or 'e'

✔ **B) They begin with a consonant SOUND — the 'yoo' sound**

C) They are proper nouns

D) They are uncountable nouns

■ *Despite beginning with vowel LETTERS (u, e), these words begin with the consonant SOUND 'yoo' (as in 'you'). Since the sound is a consonant sound, 'a' is used, not 'an.'*

Q71. When is 'the' used with a SINGULAR noun to represent a whole class? ● HARD

A) When the noun is a proper noun

B) When the noun is uncountable

✔ **C) When a singular noun represents an entire species or category — e.g., 'The cow is a useful animal'**

D) When the noun has already been mentioned

■ *'The' + singular noun can represent the WHOLE CLASS. 'The cow is useful' = all cows are useful. This is equivalent to 'Cows are useful animals.' This is a special generic use of the definite article.*

Q72. 'The Ganga, the Sahara, the Himalayas, the West Indies' — 'the' is used before these because they are: ● HARD

A) Names of countries

✔ **B) Rivers, deserts, mountain ranges, and groups of islands — specific categories of place-names**

C) Abstract nouns

D) Names of books

■ *The material lists specific categories requiring 'the': oceans/seas, rivers, canals, deserts, groups of islands, mountain ranges, and a few country names. Ganga = river, Sahara = desert, Himalayas = mountain range, West Indies = group of islands.*

Q73. Which of the following does NOT require 'the' before a proper name? ● HARD

A) The Vedas (name of a book)

B) The Nile (river)

✔ **C) Mount Everest (individual mountain peak)**

D) The Suez Canal (canal)

■ *Individual mountain PEAKS do not take 'the' — only mountain RANGES do (the Himalayas, the Alps). 'The Vedas' (books), 'The Nile' (river), 'The Suez Canal' (canal) all correctly use 'the.'*

SECTION 11: PRONOUNS

Q74. A Pronoun is defined as: ● MED

A) A word used to describe a noun

✔ **B) A word used instead of a noun**

C) A word that joins nouns together

D) A word that shows the number of nouns

■ *A Pronoun is used INSTEAD of a noun to avoid repetition. 'Hari is absent because HE is ill' — 'he' replaces 'Hari.' Pronoun literally means 'for a noun.'*

Q75. Which pronoun is a Personal Pronoun of the SECOND Person? ● MED

A) I

B) We

✔ **C) You**

D) They

■ *'You' denotes the person SPOKEN TO and is the Personal Pronoun of the Second Person. It is used for both singular and plural. 'I/We' = first person; 'He/She/They' = third person.*

Q76. Reflexive Pronouns are used when: ● MED

A) The pronoun refers to a different person than the subject

✔ **B) The action done by the subject turns back (reflects) upon the subject**

C) We want to emphasise the subject

D) We ask a question about the subject

■ *Reflexive Pronouns (myself, yourself, himself…) are used when the action REFLECTS back to the subject. E.g., 'I hurt myself' — I am both the doer and the receiver of the action.*

Q77. In 'He himself said so,' the word 'himself' is used as an: ● MED

A) Reflexive Pronoun

✔ **B) Emphatic Pronoun**

C) Indefinite Pronoun

D) Distributive Pronoun

■ *Here 'himself' is used for EMPHASIS — to stress that HE (and no one else) said so. This is the Emphatic use. If it were reflexive, the action would reflect back to the subject.*

Q78. In 'Every soldier and every sailor was in his place,' the pronoun 'his' is singular because: ● HARD

A) Soldiers and sailors are always male

✔ **B) Two singular nouns joined by 'and' preceded by 'each' or 'every' take a singular pronoun**

C) The verb 'was' is singular so the pronoun must match

D) The subject 'soldier' is singular

■ *Rule: When two SINGULAR nouns joined by 'and' are preceded by 'each' or 'every,' the pronoun referring to them must be SINGULAR. Each/every emphasises individuals, not the group together.*

Q79. When a Plural Noun and a Singular Noun are joined by 'or' or 'nor,' the Pronoun must be in the: ● HARD

A) Singular — agree with the nearer noun

✔ **B) Plural**

C) Whichever is mentioned first

D) No pronoun is used in such sentences

■ *Rule: When a PLURAL noun and a singular noun are joined by 'or/nor,' the pronoun must be PLURAL. E.g., 'Either the manager or his assistants failed in THEIR duty' — 'their' (plural) because one of the nouns is plural.*

Q80. Demonstrative Pronouns are used to: ● HARD

A) Ask questions
B) Refer to persons or things generally without specifying
✔ **C) Point out the objects to which they refer**
D) Distribute reference to each one individually

■ *Demonstrative Pronouns (this, that, these, those, such) POINT OUT the objects referred to. 'This is a present from my uncle' — 'this' points to a specific object. They demonstrate/show clearly.*

Q81. Distributive Pronouns (each, either, neither) are always: ● HARD

A) Plural — they refer to more than one
✔ **B) Singular — they refer to persons or things one at a time**
C) Used only with plural verbs
D) Used only in questions

■ *Each, either, and neither are Distributive Pronouns — they refer to persons or things ONE AT A TIME. They are ALWAYS SINGULAR and always followed by a verb in the singular. E.g., 'Each of the boys GETS a prize.'*

Q82. A Relative Pronoun does double work. It acts as: ● HARD

A) A noun and an adverb
✔ **B) A pronoun and a conjunction**
C) An adjective and a preposition
D) A verb and a pronoun

■ *A Relative Pronoun (who, which, that) acts as: (1) a PRONOUN — it replaces a noun, and (2) a CONJUNCTION — it joins two statements. E.g., 'I met Hari WHO had just returned' — 'who' replaces 'Hari' AND connects the two clauses.*

SECTION 12: INTERROGATIVE PRONOUNS

Q83. Interrogative Pronouns are similar in FORM to which other pronouns? ● MED

A) Personal Pronouns
B) Reflexive Pronouns
✔ **C) Relative Pronouns**
D) Indefinite Pronouns

■ *Interrogative Pronouns (who, whom, whose, which, what) are SIMILAR IN FORM to Relative Pronouns, but their WORK is different — they are used for asking questions, not joining clauses.*

Q84. Which of the following is an Interrogative Pronoun? ● MED

A) himself
B) themselves
✔ **C) whose**
D) none

■ *'Whose' is an Interrogative Pronoun used to ask about possession (Whose is this book?). 'Himself/themselves' are reflexive/emphatic; 'none' is an indefinite pronoun.*

Q85. What makes Interrogative Pronouns different from Relative Pronouns even though they look the same? ● HARD

A) Interrogative Pronouns are always plural; Relative Pronouns are singular

✔ **B) Interrogative Pronouns are used for ASKING QUESTIONS; Relative Pronouns JOIN clauses and refer back to an antecedent**

C) Interrogative Pronouns have no antecedent and appear at the end of sentences

D) They are not different — they are the same pronouns

■ *The WORK they do differs: Relative Pronouns refer back to an antecedent and join clauses ('Hari who had returned'). Interrogative Pronouns have no antecedent — they ask questions ('Who is there?').*

Q86. In 'Which do you prefer, tea or coffee?' — 'which' functions as: ● HARD

A) A Relative Pronoun

B) A Demonstrative Pronoun

✔ **C) An Interrogative Pronoun**

D) An Indefinite Pronoun

■ *'Which' here is used to ASK A QUESTION about a choice between options. It has no antecedent it refers back to — it simply asks 'which one?' making it an Interrogative Pronoun.*

Total: 86 MCQs | 12 Topics | Medium & Hard Level | ✔ Correct answers highlighted in green | ■ Every answer explained

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